

Central African Republic



Area 240,535 sq miles
(622,984 sq km)
Population 4.5 million
Capital Bangui
Currency CFA franc
Official language French
Life expectancy 44 years



The Central African Republic (CAR) has been a politically unstable country since its independence from France in 1960. CAR's main ethnic groups are the Baya and Banda.

► FISHING IN THE UBANGI

The Ubangi River is a tributary of the Congo River. It flows through the Central African Republic's capital, Bangui.



Sudan



Area 718,722 sq miles
(1,861,481 sq km)
Population 34 million
Capital Khartoum
Currency Sudanese pound
Official language Arabic
Life expectancy 58 years



Sudan was the largest country in Africa until the southern part became a separate nation in 2011. The split came after decades of civil war between the Arab north and the African south. An ongoing conflict in Darfur in western Sudan has seen some of the worst ethnic violence in recent world history.

Eritrea



Area 46,842 sq miles
(121,320 sq km)
Population 5.4 million
Capital Asmara
Currency Nakfa
Official languages Tigrinya, English, and Arabic
Life expectancy 57 years



Lying along the shore of the Red Sea, Eritrea has a landscape of rugged mountains, bush, and desert. In 1993, Eritrea gained independence from Ethiopia after a long war. Tigrinya speakers, mainly Orthodox Christians, form the largest of Eritrea's nine main ethnic groups.

South Sudan



Area 248,777 sq miles
(644,329 sq km)
Population 8.3 million
Capital Juba
Currency South Sudan pound
Official language English
Life expectancy not available



A landlocked country in sub-Saharan Africa, South Sudan won recognition as an independent nation only in 2011. It has significant oil reserves, but lack of economic development prevents the country from exploiting them. South Sudan is highly diverse, both ethnically and linguistically.



▲ MOUNTAIN FOREST

South Sudan's evergreen mountain forests are home to a wide variety of flora and fauna.

Ethiopia



Area 455,186 sq miles
(1,127,127 sq km)
Population 84.7 million
Capital Addis Ababa
Currency Birr
Official language Amharic
Life expectancy 52 years



Ethiopia is the only African country to have escaped colonization. It has 86 ethnic groups, and 286 languages. Ethiopia is drought prone and frequently faces food shortages. Its economy is highly dependent on aid, especially from the World Bank, the US, and the European Union.

Djibouti



Area 8,494 sq miles
(22,000 sq km)
Population 900,000
Capital Djibouti
Currency Djibouti franc
Official languages Arabic and French
Life expectancy 54 years



Djibouti lies in northeast Africa on the strait linking the Red Sea and the Indian Ocean. Its capital city is the main port on the Red Sea, and the main shipping terminal for East Africa. Djibouti also depends on international aid, of which almost half is provided by France.

